

Mapping With Melanin — Integrity, Accountability & Partnership Framework

Product Specification Document

1. Executive Summary

Mapping With Melanin (MWM) is a community-powered platform designed to help minorities find trusted businesses, stay safe, and connect with their community. This document outlines the comprehensive product specification for the platform's Integrity, Accountability, and Partnership Framework. It details the mechanisms for business classification, safety reporting, legal protections, partnership pipelines, diaspora contributions, and AI personalization, ensuring a safe, equitable, and legally sound environment for all users and listed businesses.

2. Business Classification Tiers

The platform categorizes businesses into distinct tiers to ensure minority-owned businesses are prioritized while providing a pathway for community-verified allied businesses.

Tier 1: Minority-Owned Businesses (PRIMARY)

This tier represents the core focus of the MWM platform.

- **Visibility:** Always shown first in search results and recommendations.
- **Features:** Full profile access, community reviews, and Kinfolk AI recommendations.
- **Opportunities:** Eligible for flash deals, creator partnerships, and demand intelligence insights.
- **Identification:** Ownership badge prominently displayed.
- **Engagement:** Actively invited and supported by the platform.

Tier 2: Allied Businesses (PASSIVE)

This tier is a critical distinction, representing non-minority-owned businesses verified as safe by the community.

- **Definition:** Non-minority-owned businesses that the community has verified as safe spaces (e.g., "Hyatt Wisconsin — Community Verified Safe Space").

- **Visibility Constraints:** NEVER promoted above a minority-owned alternative in the same category.
- **Onboarding:** NEVER contacted or alerted when first added to the platform. They remain PASSIVE entries until accumulating sufficient community engagement data.
- **Partnership Pathway:** Only AFTER sufficient tracking data (e.g., 500+ click-throughs from MWM) do they receive a partnership opportunity link. The pitch comes TO THEM based on demonstrated value.
- **Accountability:** Subject to immediate deprioritization if discrimination is reported. Can lose their listing entirely if community trust erodes.
- **Identification:** Distinct "Community Verified" badge, contrasting with the ownership badge.

3. Safety Reporting & Reporter Protection

Protecting users who report concerns is paramount. However, there is a **critical distinction** between two fundamentally different types of reports, each requiring different response protocols, timelines, and protection levels.

Report Type A: Community Safety Concerns (Visitor/Customer Experience)

These reports protect community members as **customers, visitors, or passersby**. The reporter has a transient relationship with the business — they visited once, experienced something, and left.

Examples: "I was followed in the parking lot" / "Staff used a racial slur" / "They refused to serve us" / "I felt unsafe here" / "This gas station has a history of discrimination"

Response Protocol for Type A:

Attribute	Type A — Safety Concern
Reporter relationship to business	Transient (customer/visitor)
Reporter retaliation risk	Low (they don't return daily)
Aggregation threshold	2 independent reports within 60 days
Time delay before action	7 days (shorter — community needs to know quickly)
Visibility to community	Affects public-facing trust score

What community sees	"Community safety concern reported" on the business listing
Purpose	Protect the NEXT person who might visit
Graduated response speed	Faster — safety is urgent

Type A reports directly affect the business's community trust score and can trigger the graduated response system (Levels 1-5) more quickly because the priority is **preventing harm to the next visitor**. The reporter is relatively safe because they have no ongoing relationship with the business.

Report Type B: Unfair Labor & Workplace Practices (Employee Experience)

These reports protect community members as **employees or job applicants**. The reporter has an ongoing, daily relationship with the business — they go back to that workplace every day. This creates an extreme retaliation risk.

Examples: "They pay below minimum wage" / "Hostile work environment for Black employees" / "They fired someone for wearing natural hair" / "Retaliation against employees who speak up" / "Discriminatory promotion practices"

Response Protocol for Type B:

Attribute	Type B — Labor/Workplace Report
Reporter relationship to business	Ongoing (employee/applicant)
Reporter retaliation risk	EXTREME (they return daily, can be fired)
Aggregation threshold	3+ independent reports over 90+ days
Time delay before action	30-60 days minimum (maximum protection)
Visibility to community	Does NOT affect public-facing trust score initially
What community sees	Private warning to members considering employment: "Community members have reported workplace concerns"
Purpose	Warn potential employees WITHOUT endangering current ones
Graduated response speed	Slow and deliberate — reporter safety is paramount

Type B reports are handled with **maximum reporter protection** because the reporter is trapped in a daily relationship with the business. The system must ensure that even if only one person from a small team files a report, they cannot be identified through temporal correlation, team size analysis, or any other inference.

Separation of Scores

Businesses maintain TWO independent trust dimensions:

1. **Visitor Safety Score** — informed by Type A reports. Visible to all community members browsing/searching. Affects search ranking and recommendations.
2. **Employer Trust Score** — informed by Type B reports. Visible ONLY to community members who are actively searching for jobs or who ask Kinfolk AI about working somewhere. Does NOT affect the business's visibility as a place to visit/shop.

This separation is critical: a restaurant might be a wonderful place to eat (high visitor safety) but a terrible place to work (low employer trust). These are independent assessments that serve different community needs.

The Critical Problem

If an employer is consistently ranked negatively for workplace discrimination, the system MUST NOT allow the report to be traced back to a specific employee. Consider: if there is one Black gay woman in a 50-person office, and a workplace discrimination report appears the week she started, she could be identified and retaliated against — even fired.

Protection Mechanisms (Apply to BOTH types, with stricter thresholds for Type B)

1. **Anonymous Aggregation Threshold:** No action is taken on a single report. Type A requires 2 independent reports within 60 days. Type B requires 3+ independent reports over 90+ days. This prevents temporal correlation.
2. **Time-Delayed Visibility:** Reports are collected, but their effects are NOT immediately visible. Type A: 7-day delay. Type B: 30-60 day delay. The longer delay for Type B prevents anyone from correlating "a report appeared right after Person X started."
3. **Geographic Fuzzing:** For Type B (labor) reports, concerns are aggregated at the brand/chain level, not individual location level, until the threshold is high enough. "[Brand] has received workplace concerns" — not "[Brand] at [specific address]." Type A reports can be location-specific once threshold is met because visitor safety is location-dependent.

4. **No Individual Attribution:** The platform NEVER reveals how many reports exist, who reported, when reports were filed, or any metadata that could identify reporters. The only visible output is the aggregated score change.
5. **Reporter Identity Separation:** Reports are stored with a one-way hash of the reporter's ID. Even database administrators cannot easily correlate reports to specific users without a deliberate forensic query.
6. **Retaliation Detection:** If a user's account is reported or flagged shortly after they filed a safety report, the system flags this as potential retaliation for administrative review.
7. **Team Size Protection (Type B only):** If the system detects that a business has fewer than 10 community members associated with it as employees (based on profile data), Type B reports require an even HIGHER threshold (5+ reports) before any action, because small teams make individual identification easier.

Report Submission Flow

When a community member submits a report, the first question is:

"How did you experience this?"

- "I visited or shopped here" → Type A (Safety Concern)
- "I work here or applied for a job here" → Type B (Workplace Report)

This single question determines the entire protection protocol. Type B reporters see an additional reassurance message: "Your report is protected by our maximum-security protocol. It will never be visible until multiple independent community members share similar experiences over an extended period. Your identity is cryptographically separated from your report."

4. Legal Protection Framework

To mitigate the risk of defamation lawsuits from deprioritized businesses, MWM must operate strictly as a platform, not a publisher.

Defamation Mitigation Strategy

1. **Platform vs. Publisher Distinction (Section 230):** MWM is a platform for community-reported experiences, NOT making editorial judgments. Language must reflect this (e.g., "Community members have shared concerns" instead of "This business discriminates"). All visible safety information is attributed to community consensus.
2. **Terms of Service Requirements:** All businesses listed agree to community feedback visibility. Allied businesses are listed as community resources, not commercial listings.

A clear disclaimer must be present: "Trust scores reflect aggregated community experiences and do not represent the views of Mapping With Melanin, Inc."

3. **No Defamatory Statements:** Never use words like "discriminates," "racist," or "unsafe" as platform-generated labels. Use neutral, factual language like "Community trust score: Low" or "Community concerns reported." Allow businesses a right of reply.
4. **Graduated Response System:**
 - **Level 1:** No visible change (collecting data).
 - **Level 2:** Subtle deprioritization in search results (not visible to the business).
 - **Level 3:** "Community concerns noted" badge appears (business notified, can respond).
 - **Level 4:** Business removed from recommendations but still searchable.
 - **Level 5:** Business delisted (only for severe/verified cases, with human review).
5. **Human Review Gate:** No business is publicly flagged or delisted without human (admin) review. Automated systems only handle Levels 1-2. Levels 3-5 require founder/admin approval.
6. **Documentation Trail:** Every trust score change is logged with the aggregated reason, providing a legal defense based on acting on aggregated community feedback following published policy.

5. Partnership Pipeline (for Allied Businesses)

This pipeline defines the journey from a passive community listing to an active partner.

Stage	Name	Description	Criteria
Stage 1	Community Addition (Day 0)	Added by community; business is not contacted.	3+ independent nominations.
Stage 2	Data Accumulation (Days 1-90)	Tracking views, clicks, saves, and mentions.	N/A (Data gathering phase).
Stage 3	Partnership Threshold Reached	System flags for admin review based on engagement.	500+ click-throughs OR 100+ saves OR 50+ direction requests.
Stage 4	Outreach (Admin-initiated)	MWM sends a partnership pitch based on proven value.	Admin approval required.
Stage 5	Active Partner	Access to analytics dashboard, ability to	Paid partnership fee; must maintain

		respond to feedback.	community trust.
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Note: Active partners are still NEVER promoted above minority-owned alternatives.

6. Diaspora International Business Contributions

This feature allows members to add trusted businesses from their home countries or travels.

Contribution Flow

1. **Identification:** Member identifies as part of the diaspora during onboarding.
2. **Prompt:** In-app prompt encourages adding safe spaces in specific countries.
3. **Data Capture:** Form captures business name, location, relationship (owner, family, visitor, community recommended), safety context (e.g., LGBTQIA+, Black travelers), and cultural context.
4. **Trust Weighting:**
 - "I own this" → Highest trust (verified via claim flow).
 - "Family owns this" → High trust.
 - "I've visited" → Medium trust.
 - "Community recommended" → Requires 2+ independent confirmations.
5. **Privacy Considerations:**
 - Safety tags (e.g., LGBTQIA+) may only be visible to users who self-identify similarly in regions where such labels pose risks.
 - Contributors can remain anonymous.
 - The system eventually seeks owner confirmation, but listings can exist based on community trust.

7. Onboarding → Kinfolk AI Pipeline

Data collected during onboarding must immediately feed the Kinfolk AI to provide personalized experiences from day one.

Data Utilization Strategy

1. **Immediate Storage:** Onboarding data (safety preferences, travel interests, identity/diaspora designations) is immediately stored server-side.

2. **Profile Creation:** Creates an initial Kinfolk AI profile based on stated preferences.
3. **Day One Personalization:** Kinfolk uses this profile to personalize recommendations immediately.
4. **Continuous Refinement:** Over time, Kinfolk confirms and refines preferences based on behavioral signals (searches, saves, reviews). Example: "We noticed you save a lot of Caribbean restaurants..."

8. Accountability Without Surveillance

The platform must operate on the principle that it learns from what users CHOOSE to share, never from what it secretly observes.

- **Location Data:** Used only when explicitly granted and for stated purposes.
- **Search History:** Feeds recommendations, but users can view and delete their history.
- **AI Transparency:** Kinfolk AI explains the reasoning behind recommendations.
- **User Control:** Users can correct Kinfolk's assumptions.
- **Value Exchange:** All data collection is permission-based with a clear value proposition (e.g., "Share your travel plans → get safety tips for your route").

9. Community Marketplace & Talent Pipeline

This section introduces a three-tier model for business classification, expanding the platform to include informal community entrepreneurs, and establishes an organic talent discovery pipeline driven by community signals.

Three Business Tiers

The platform categorizes businesses and community offerings into a three-tier model to support both established entities and grassroots entrepreneurs.

1. **Verified Business** — Established and formally registered entities (e.g., LLCs, possessing necessary permits). These businesses receive a full verification badge and primary placement in search results. This tier encompasses the existing Tier 1 (Minority-Owned) and Tier 2 (Allied) businesses that have completed formal registration.
2. **Community Entrepreneur** — Informal businesses, such as home chefs selling platters, bead makers, or braiders working from their kitchens. They typically maintain a social media presence (e.g., Instagram or TikTok) but lack formal business registration.
 - **Pricing:** ALWAYS FREE to list. The platform will never charge individuals pursuing their entrepreneurial dreams.

- **Visibility:** Not included in the main business search by default. They are discoverable when users search specifically for their offerings (e.g., "home cooked meals near me").
 - **Identification:** Clearly distinguished from verified businesses with a unique badge or indicator.
 - **Growth Pathway:** Can UPGRADE to Verified Business status when they are ready (e.g., upon acquiring an LLC and permits).
 - **Integration:** Shows their social media directly, with Instagram, TikTok, or Facebook feeds embedded in their profile.
 - **Community Validation:** Supported by community reviews and "put your people on" endorsements.
 - **Categorization:** Tagged by specific skills or offerings, such as "Home Chef," "Natural Hair," "Handmade Jewelry," or "Event Planning."
3. **External Reference** — Businesses added to the platform by community members via a social media link, which have not yet claimed their profile. These listings display the business's actual social media feed alongside community references from MWM members who have visited.

Community Entrepreneur Experience — Full Specification

This subsection details the specific experience, capabilities, and growth pathway for the **Community Entrepreneur** tier, ensuring a supportive environment for grassroots businesses to thrive without the pressures of formal business operations.

A. What Community Entrepreneurs Receive (Their Capabilities)

Community Entrepreneurs are provided with a suite of tools designed to help them share their skills and products with the community. They receive:

- **Marketplace Listing:** Placement in a dedicated "Community Entrepreneurs" or "Local Makers" section.
- **Community Profile:** A dedicated space to showcase their offerings.
- **Product/Service Showcasing:** The ability to post products and services with accompanying photos.
- **Pop-up Announcements:** The ability to post upcoming pop-ups with specific location and date tags.
- **Community Reviews:** Full, unlimited community reviews, which are critical for building trust and feeding the talent pipeline.

- **Endorsements:** Community recommendations and "put your people on" endorsements.
- **Ratings:** A visible rating system based on community feedback.
- **Story Video:** One story video prompted at listing time ("Tell your community why you do this").
- **Social Media Linking:** Direct links to their social media profiles (e.g., Instagram, TikTok).
- **Community Feed Integration:** Community feed posts that link back to their Marketplace profile (e.g., "I'm at Clark Park today!" or "New bracelet collection dropped").

B. What Community Entrepreneurs DO NOT Get

To maintain clear boundaries between formal businesses and grassroots entrepreneurs, and to prevent abuse, Community Entrepreneurs do not have access to:

- Advertising or promoted listings.
- The "Verified Business" badge.
- Storefront analytics or business insights.
- Employee or team member profiles.
- Booking integrations (Direct Commerce is reserved for verified businesses).
- Multiple locations or multiple brands.
- Wholesale inventory listings.
- Nationwide shipping capabilities.
- Any subscription fees (this tier is ALWAYS FREE).

C. How They Appear in Search (Visual/Discovery Distinction)

Discovery is designed to celebrate all levels of entrepreneurship while maintaining clear expectations for users. When a user searches for a category (e.g., "Jewelry"), the results are structured as follows:

- **Verified Businesses:** Displayed first (e.g., 18 results).
- **Community Entrepreneurs:** Clearly separated and displayed below the verified businesses (e.g., 7 results).

Each Community Entrepreneur card displays their name, their offerings, a snippet of their story, their community endorsement count, and a distinct "Community Entrepreneur" label. Furthermore, they are NOT buried in the community feed. The feed is reserved for conversation, while commerce occurs in the Marketplace. Feed posts (e.g., "I'll be at the Juneteenth Festival") serve to link back to their marketplace profile.

D. The Marketplace Section

The Marketplace is a distinct section of the application, separate from the community feed. Here, Community Entrepreneurs reside alongside Verified Businesses but are clearly distinguished. Users can browse by category and apply filters such as "Community Entrepreneurs only" or "Verified Businesses only." Notably, pop-up vendors are categorized as a tag within Community Entrepreneurs, rather than a separate tier.

E. The Upgrade Journey ("Growing Together")

The platform actively supports the transition from Community Entrepreneur to Verified Business through an organic upgrade journey. Kinfolk AI monitors for growth signals rather than relying solely on hard thresholds. These signals include:

- Selling consistently for 90+ days.
- Growing review count and quality.
- Community members inquiring about hours or availability.
- Receiving payments regularly.
- Achieving any combination of milestones, such as 50+ completed sales, 100+ reviews, or 250+ followers.

When these patterns emerge, Kinfolk AI celebrates the milestone rather than issuing a warning:

"🎉 Your community has supported you through more than 100 sales! You're now eligible to become a Verified Business. Verification unlocks additional tools, greater visibility, and helps customers recognize your growing brand."

This upgrade is NEVER forced; it is always encouraged. The prompt is designed to feel organic, not like unlocking a game achievement. The three-tier growth path for launch is: **Community Entrepreneur → Verified Business → Community Partner**. Crucially, all history (reviews, endorsements, sales records) carries forward upon upgrade; entrepreneurs never start fresh.

F. Upgrade Incentives (What Verified Unlocks)

Transitioning to a Verified Business unlocks significant premium features designed to support formal business operations:

- The Verified badge.
- Higher search placement.
- Business insights and analytics.
- Direct Commerce capabilities (booking integrations, in-app transactions).
- Prominent display of a website link.

- Event creation tools.
- Team members and employee profiles.
- Promotional campaigns.
- Customer messaging capabilities.
- Access to the premium membership tier.

G. Abuse Prevention Guardrails

Guardrails are essential to protect the integrity of the tier system without punishing legitimate growth. If a Community Entrepreneur begins operating like a full business (e.g., managing multiple locations, hiring employees, selling wholesale inventory, or exhibiting franchise behavior), Kinfolk AI will prompt them to upgrade. If they refuse to upgrade while clearly operating at a business scale, an administrative review is triggered.

H. Connection to the Talent Pipeline

The Marketplace serves as the primary data source for the talent pipeline. Kinfolk AI monitors marketplace activity to facilitate talent matches. For example, a home chef who accumulates 47 five-star reviews in the marketplace is the same individual Kinfolk will connect to a restaurant owner seeking culinary talent. Reviews, endorsements, and sales patterns collectively inform the talent matching algorithm.

I. Story Prompt at Onboarding

When a Community Entrepreneur first creates a listing, they are presented with a prompt: "Tell your community why you do this." This can be fulfilled via a short video or text and directly feeds Layer 1 of the Business Profile Card content hierarchy. Examples include:

"I started making candles after my grandmother passed — each scent is one of her recipes." "I braid hair because my mother taught me and I want every little girl to feel beautiful."

Social Media Integration Philosophy

The platform's approach to social media integration is designed to amplify creators without cannibalizing their audience.

- The platform embeds TikTok and Instagram content directly and will never rehost content.
- The primary goal is to drive traffic TO the creators' existing pages, actively tracking click-throughs to demonstrate value.
- Content creators retain their followers and brand identity; MWM simply connects them to the right audience.

- When a community member mentions a business (e.g., tagging a tour shop in Mexico), the listing displays that business's actual social media feed, supplemented by community references from MWM members who have visited.
- MWM never asks anyone to start over or risk losing their established followers.

Business Profile Card — Content Hierarchy

When a user taps a map pin or business card, they encounter a rich profile experience that lives INSIDE the MWM app. This profile is not merely a link to external content — it is the **introduction layer** where trust is built before any transaction occurs. The content hierarchy on a business profile card follows a deliberate sequence:

Layer 1 — The Business's Own Story (uploaded directly to MWM):

Businesses are prompted to create content that connects them emotionally to their community. This content is personal and community-facing — it may not appear on their public website or social media. Examples include a bakery owner sharing: "I opened this bakery because I remember spending every Saturday morning helping my grandmother bake cookies. She made the best cookies." Or a wig maker explaining: "I decided to make wigs because my mother and I were cancer survivors." This story video and accompanying photos are the first thing users see — the human connection that makes the community care.

Layer 2 — Community Voice:

Aggregated community endorsements appear as concise, powerful snippets. For example: "1,001 people said this is the sharpest lineup in town." This layer includes "put your people on" endorsements, review highlights, and community trust signals. Users see a brief snippet with the option to read more.

Layer 3 — Cultural Ambassador Content:

Videos or posts from content creators (Cultural Ambassadors) who have featured this business are embedded directly on the card. If a food blogger filmed a review of this restaurant, or a travel creator featured this excursion company, that content appears here — driving visibility for both the business and the creator.

Layer 4 — Outbound Link (The Handoff):

After the introduction is complete — after the user has seen the story, felt the community trust, and watched ambassador content — the "Book a Service," "Visit Their Page," or "See More" button takes them to the business's actual website or social media. This is where MWM hands off and drives traffic TO them. Click-throughs are tracked to demonstrate value to the business.

The Key Principle: MWM makes the introduction. The business owns the transaction. The introduction happens inside MWM (story, trust, community voice). The transaction happens on the business's own turf — unless the business opts into Direct Commerce.

Tier-Based Content Capabilities:

What businesses can upload to their MWM profile (videos, photos, story content) is determined by their tier and subscription level, keeping costs economically feasible while giving everyone a way to tell their story.

Tier	Story Video	Photos	Community Reviews	Ambassador Content	Outbound Link
Verified Business	Yes (unlimited)	Yes (gallery)	Yes	Yes (featured)	Yes
Community Entrepreneur	Yes (1 intro video)	Yes (limited gallery)	Yes	Yes (if tagged)	Yes (social media)
External Reference	No (not yet claimed)	No	Yes (community-added)	Yes (if tagged)	Yes (social media)

Direct Commerce Layer (Verified Businesses Only)

For verified businesses that opt in, MWM offers a **Direct Commerce** capability — allowing users to book services, purchase tickets, or reserve experiences without ever leaving the app. This is a premium feature available exclusively to verified businesses and represents a key revenue stream for the platform.

Why Direct Commerce Exists:

Direct Commerce is not merely a convenience feature — it is fundamentally a **safety and continuity feature** for the MWM ecosystem.

- **Traveler Security:** When someone books a Brazil excursion through MWM, the platform has a record of it. If something goes wrong, the system knows where they were supposed to be. Kinfolk can proactively check in: "You booked a snorkeling trip tomorrow — want us to share your itinerary with your Circle?" This transforms a simple booking into a safety net.
- **Uniform Experience:** Whether a user is booking a barber in Charlotte, an excursion in Cabo, or buying tickets to a jazz festival in New Orleans, the booking flow looks and feels identical. Consistent, trusted, familiar — regardless of the business's own website quality or payment system.

- **Event Intelligence:** When event promoters sell tickets through MWM, the platform knows who is attending. This enables safety tips for the venue area, Circle connections ("4 of your Circle members are also going to this event"), and community engagement tracking.
- **Ecosystem Data:** Every in-app transaction feeds the ecosystem — Kinfolk learns what experiences resonate, which businesses deliver, and what the community values.

Direct Commerce Capabilities:

Commerce Type	Example	Safety Integration
Service Booking	Barber appointment, spa reservation	Kinfolk reminder + location sharing with Circle
Experience/Excursion	Snorkeling in Brazil, city tour	Itinerary shared with safety contacts; check-in prompts
Event Tickets	Jazz festival, cultural celebration	Attendee connections; venue safety tips; group coordination
Reservations	Restaurant table, accommodation	Travel plan integration; area safety context

"My Bookings" — The Return Path:

After any direct commerce transaction, the user gains a persistent record in their "My Bookings" section (tied to their community member profile). This includes:

- Confirmation and receipt (lives in the app permanently).
- Kinfolk reminders: "Your excursion in Brazil is in 3 days — here are safety tips for that area."
- Easy rebooking: "You loved this barber last month — book again?"
- Post-experience prompts: "How was your trip? Your review helps the next traveler."
- Safety continuity: If a user doesn't check in after a booked experience, the system can alert their Circle.

Revenue Model for Direct Commerce:

MWM applies a small transaction fee (comparable to platforms like Eventbrite or Square) on direct commerce transactions — but ONLY for verified businesses who opt into this premium feature. Community entrepreneurs still list free and link out to their own platforms. The transaction fee funds the platform's safety infrastructure, give-back programs, and operational costs.

Non-negotiable rule: Community entrepreneurs are NEVER required to use Direct Commerce. They always retain the option to link out to their own payment methods (Venmo, CashApp, their own website). Direct Commerce is a premium convenience for verified businesses, not a tollgate for community entrepreneurs.

Talent Pipeline (Kinfolk AI Matching)

The platform facilitates organic talent discovery based on community signals, moving beyond traditional job boards.

- **Trigger Mechanism:** When a community entrepreneur achieves a specific threshold of positive feedback (e.g., a home chef receiving 47 five-star reviews), Kinfolk AI initiates a connection.
- **Employer Prompt:** Kinfolk prompts a nearby relevant business: "A community member has exceptional reviews for Caribbean cuisine — looking for kitchen talent?"
- **Talent Prompt:** Kinfolk simultaneously prompts the entrepreneur: "Your platter reviews are outstanding. 3 restaurants in your area are looking for Caribbean cuisine expertise. Would you like to be connected?"
- **Cost Structure:** Neither party pays for this match; it is an organic benefit created by the ecosystem.
- **Examples:** This pipeline can facilitate connections such as a home chef becoming a restaurant sous chef, an event planner partnering as a venue coordinator, or a natural hair braider joining a salon.

Dual Profiles

To support the multifaceted roles of community members, the platform allows users to maintain both a business profile AND a community member profile simultaneously. For instance, a restaurant owner in DC can also act as a community member who discovers a home chef's talent. These profiles are linked but serve distinct purposes within the ecosystem.

Verification Filter

Users are empowered to control their search experience. They can filter search results to display only verified businesses. While unverified community entrepreneurs are visible and clearly distinguished, the application of this filter remains a user choice, not a platform default.

Revenue and Give-Back Model

The platform's revenue model is designed to generate profit without exploiting grassroots entrepreneurs.

Revenue Model:

- Community entrepreneurs can list for FREE, permanently. This is a non-negotiable principle.
- MWM takes NO cut from the sales generated by community entrepreneurs.
- Revenue is derived from: Allied business partnerships, premium features for verified businesses, Direct Commerce transaction fees (verified businesses only), and eventually, impact data provided to grant foundations and corporate sponsors.
- The talent pipeline matching service remains free for both sides.
- Direct Commerce transaction fees apply only to verified businesses who opt in — never to community entrepreneurs.

Give-Back Model (When revenue allows):

- **Scholarships:** Culinary school scholarships for home chefs who reach a specific review threshold.
- **Registration Assistance:** Support for business registration, including LLC filing, permits, and food handler certifications.
- **Mentorship:** Matching verified business owners with community entrepreneurs for guidance.
- **Micro-grants:** Financial support for community entrepreneurs who are ready to formalize their businesses.
- **The Full Circle:** A community member sells platters, receives excellent reviews, and is connected by Kinfolk to a restaurant owner. She then becomes a sous chef or receives a micro-grant to open her own establishment. Ultimately, she becomes a Verified Business and mentors the next generation of home chefs.

10. Implementation Priority

Given the existing codebase, the implementation is phased as follows:

Phase 1 (Pre-tour, website only)

- Add "ambassador" as a valid `previewChoice` in the waitlist.
- Develop the partnership tracking dashboard (admin view of `external-clicks` analytics).

Phase 2 (Post-Apple-approval)

- Implement Allied Business tier distinction in the business model.
- Connect deprioritization logic to safety reports.
- Implement the anonymous aggregation threshold system.
- Ensure onboarding data flows to server-side storage and Kinfolk profile creation.

Phase 3 (Post-tour)

- Automate partnership outreach (threshold-based notifications).
- Implement the diaspora international business contribution flow.
- Develop Kinfolk confirmation prompts.
- Implement the legal framework (ToS updates, response system for businesses).

Phase 4 (Post-tour, revenue-dependent)

- Implement Community Entrepreneur listing flow with social media embedding.
- Build the four-layer Business Profile Card (story video, community voice, ambassador content, outbound link).
- Build Kinfolk AI talent matching engine.
- Develop give-back program infrastructure (scholarship tracking, micro-grant applications).
- Implement dual profile system.
- Build verification upgrade pathway (Community Entrepreneur → Verified Business).

Phase 5 (Revenue-generating, post-critical-mass)

- Implement Direct Commerce layer (Stripe integration, unified booking flow).
- Build "My Bookings" section with safety integration (itinerary sharing, check-in prompts, Circle alerts).
- Implement event ticket sales for promoters.
- Build rebooking engine with Kinfolk prompts.
- Develop transaction fee infrastructure and reporting dashboard.

Developer Guidelines (Replit Integration)

This section details how the new requirements integrate with the existing MWM codebase.

1. Partnership Tracking Dashboard

The existing `/external-clicks` endpoint captures the necessary data (`institutionName` , `institutionType` , `institutionUrl` , `referenceType` , `referenceId` , `source` , `isSafetyRelated` , `city` , `state` , `userId`).

- **Action:** Build an admin dashboard that aggregates this data.
- **Query Logic:** Group by `referenceId` (business ID) where `institutionType` is 'Allied'. Sum the occurrences to track progress toward the Stage 3 thresholds (e.g., 500+ click-throughs).

2. Safety Reporting & Deprioritization

The existing endpoints (`/reports` , `/reports/proximity-warnings` , `/incidents` , `/safety-tips` , `/safety-context`) need to be integrated with the new threshold logic.

- **Action:** Modify the reporting logic to store reporter IDs as a one-way hash.
- **Aggregation Logic:** Implement a background job (or query logic) that checks for the 3+ independent reports within a 30-day window condition before updating a business's aggregated trust score.
- **Visibility Delay:** Add a `visible_after` timestamp to aggregated trust score updates, set to 14-30 days after the threshold is met.

3. Onboarding to Kinfolk AI

Onboarding data (ownership designations, diaspora countries) must be pushed to the server immediately.

- **Action:** Ensure the onboarding flow makes an API call to store this data against the user's profile upon completion, rather than just relying on local `AsyncStorage` .
- **Kinfolk Integration:** The Kinfolk AI service must query this user profile data to initialize its context for recommendations.

4. API Schema Updates (Conceptual)

JSON

```
// Example update to Business Schema to support Tiers and Trust Scores
{
  "businessId": "uuid",
  "name": "string",
  "tier": "Minority-Owned | Allied",
  "trustScore": {
    "level": 1, // 1-5 scale based on Graduated Response
  }
}
```

```

    "lastUpdated": "timestamp",
    "visibleAfter": "timestamp" // Implements Time-Delayed Visibility
  },
  "engagementMetrics": {
    "clicks": "number",
    "saves": "number",
    "directionRequests": "number"
  }
}

```

5. Community Marketplace & Talent Pipeline

The following schema and integration points support the Community Marketplace and Talent Pipeline described in Section 9.

Schema Concept — Extended Business/Listing Profile:

JSON

```

// Extended listing schema to support all three business tiers
{
  "listingId": "uuid",
  "name": "string",
  "listing_type": "verified | community_entrepreneur | external_reference",
  "tier": "Minority-Owned | Allied | null", // null for community_entrepreneur
  "socialMedia": {
    "instagram": "url | null",
    "tiktok": "url | null",
    "facebook": "url | null"
  },
  "skills": ["Home Chef", "Natural Hair", "Handmade Jewelry", "Event Planning"]
  "talentPipeline": {
    "reviewCount": "number",
    "averageRating": "number",
    "kinfolkMatchEligible": "boolean", // true when threshold is met
    "lastMatchPromptSent": "timestamp | null"
  },
  "dualProfileLink": {
    "communityMemberId": "uuid | null", // links to the owner's community member profile
    "businessProfileId": "uuid | null" // links to the owner's business profile
  },
  "communityEntrepreneurData": {
    "isPopUpVendor": "boolean",
    "storySnippet": "string | null",
    "endorsementCount": "number",
    "upgradeEligibility": {
      "isEligible": "boolean",
      "metrics": {

```

```

      "daysSelling": "number",
      "completedSales": "number",
      "followerCount": "number"
    },
    "lastPromptedAt": "timestamp | null"
  }
}
}

```

- **Social Media Embed Integration Points:** Implement oEmbed or iframe-based embedding for TikTok and Instagram feeds directly within listing profiles. Track outbound click-throughs per listing to provide creators with engagement data.
- **Kinfolk AI Talent Matching Trigger Logic:** Implement a background job that evaluates `reviewCount` and `averageRating` against a configurable threshold (e.g., 40+ reviews at 4.5+ stars). Upon threshold breach, generate and queue match prompts for both the entrepreneur and nearby relevant verified businesses. The talent matching algorithm **MUST** use the marketplace activity (reviews, endorsements, sales patterns) as its primary data source.
- **Dual Profile Linking Mechanism:** Extend the user schema with a `profiles` array that can contain both a `community_member` profile and a `business` profile. The `dualProfileLink` fields on each profile object provide bidirectional references, allowing Kinfolk AI to surface relevant talent signals regardless of which profile context the user is browsing in.
- **Community Entrepreneur Listing Flow:** When a user creates a Community Entrepreneur listing, the onboarding flow **MUST** prompt them with: "Tell your community why you do this." This input (video or text) populates the `storySnippet` or `profileContent.storyVideo` and feeds Layer 1 of the Business Profile Card.
- **Upgrade Trigger Logic ("Growing Together"):** Implement a cron job or event-driven listener that monitors `communityEntrepreneurData.metrics`. When growth signals are detected (e.g., >90 days selling, 50+ sales, 100+ reviews, or 250+ followers), update `upgradeEligibility.isEligible` to true. This triggers a celebratory Kinfolk AI prompt encouraging the user to upgrade to a Verified Business. Ensure all historical data (reviews, sales) is migrated/retained upon upgrade.
- **Abuse Prevention Guardrails:** Implement checks during listing updates. If a Community Entrepreneur attempts to add multiple locations, employee profiles, or wholesale inventory (features restricted to Verified Businesses), intercept the action and prompt them to upgrade. If they bypass or refuse, flag the `listingId` for admin review.

6. Business Profile Card & Direct Commerce

The following schema and integration points support the Business Profile Card content hierarchy and Direct Commerce layer described in Section 9.

Schema Concept — Business Profile Content:

JSON

```
// Business profile content schema (story, media, commerce)
{
  "listingId": "uuid",
  "profileContent": {
    "storyVideo": {
      "url": "string | null",
      "thumbnail": "string | null",
      "uploadedAt": "timestamp"
    },
    "photos": [
      { "url": "string", "caption": "string | null", "order": "number" }
    ],
    "maxPhotos": "number" // determined by tier: verified=unlimited, entrepreneur=10
  },
  "communityVoice": {
    "endorsementCount": "number",
    "topSnippet": "string", // e.g., "\"1,001 people said this is the sharpest putYourPeopleOnCount\": \"number\""
  },
  "ambassadorContent": [
    { "creatorId": "uuid", "embedUrl": "string", "platform": "tiktok | instagram" }
  ],
  "directCommerce": {
    "enabled": "boolean", // only true for verified businesses who opt in
    "commerceType": "service_booking | experience | event_tickets | reservation",
    "bookingUrl": "string | null", // internal MWM booking endpoint
    "transactionFeePercent": "number" // platform fee (e.g., 3-5%)
  },
  "outboundLink": {
    "url": "string",
    "type": "website | instagram | tiktok | facebook",
    "clickCount": "number" // tracked for partnership value demonstration
  }
}
```

Schema Concept — My Bookings:

JSON

```
// User bookings schema
{
```

```

"bookingId": "uuid",
"userId": "uuid",
"listingId": "uuid",
"commerceType": "service_booking | experience | event_tickets | reservation",
"status": "confirmed | completed | cancelled",
"bookedAt": "timestamp",
"scheduledFor": "timestamp",
"location": { "lat": "number", "lng": "number", "city": "string" },
"safetyIntegration": {
  "itinerarySharedWithCircle": "boolean",
  "checkInExpectedAt": "timestamp | null",
  "checkInReceived": "boolean",
  "kinfolkReminders": ["3_days_before", "1_day_before", "day_of"]
},
"receipt": {
  "amount": "number",
  "currency": "string",
  "transactionId": "string"
}
}

```

- **Profile Card Rendering:** When a user taps a pin or business card, render the four-layer content hierarchy in order: (1) Story video/photos, (2) Community voice snippet, (3) Ambassador content embeds, (4) Outbound link or Direct Commerce CTA. The card must feel like a personal introduction, not a directory listing.
- **Direct Commerce Integration:** Implement a unified booking flow that handles all four commerce types (service, experience, tickets, reservation) with a consistent UI. Integrate with Stripe or equivalent for payment processing. Transaction fees are applied server-side and never visible to the end user.
- **Safety Integration Points:** Upon booking confirmation, trigger Kinfolk to offer itinerary sharing with the user's Circle. Schedule check-in prompts based on the booking's `scheduledFor` timestamp. If `checkInExpectedAt` passes without a check-in, escalate to Circle notification after a configurable grace period.
- **Rebooking Engine:** Track completed bookings and surface rebooking prompts via Kinfolk: "You loved this barber last month — book again?" Frequency is user-controllable to prevent notification fatigue.